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The state government has paid special attention to improve the quality of higher education over the last five years. The Private University Act has been brought to facilitate establishment of private universities by internationally renowned and reputed educational institutions in the state. This would also enable the institutions to offer courses in tune with the requirements created by industrialization and globalization. This is a good initiative to channelise the energy of private sector for public welfare. As part of the efforts to improve quality of higher education, semester system has been introduced in all colleges. Comprehensive Continuous Evaluation (CCE) and project work are the special features of this system. Results have shown improvement because of constant instruction of the students.

At the same time, the state government has taken steps to fully safeguard the interests of students. A fees regulatory committee has been constituted by enacting a law. The committee is determining the fees as per quality of facilities in medical, technical and management institutions. This would strike a balance between the interests of the students and the institutions. Madhya Pradesh is one of the few states to have set up fees regulatory committee by enacting a law as per the directive of the Supreme Court.

With a view to associating the students with college management and to educate them on democracy, the direct elections to the students unions of colleges were held simultaneously in all the colleges as per recommendations of the Lyngdoh Committee. Direct elections to the students unions of colleges have been held after a long gap of twenty years, which is a significant achievement.

As part of measures to improve quality of educational new arrangement has been put in place for a continuous direct dialogue between teachers and the administration. IT is being widely used in the functioning of the Higher Education department. Through the website the directives are issued to all the colleges simultaneously and their implementation is being ensured. A weekly video conferencing is held between senior officers of the department with the principals. This exercise has enabled solution to the pending problems of colleges and it becomes possible to find out the status of implementation of the directives issued by the department.

It also saves money and time, which would have otherwise spent on journey by concerning persons.

Over the last five years, the state government has followed the policy of not opening new colleges and to strengthen the existing ones instead. There is a target to construct buildings of all the colleges. Computer education has been introduced at graduate level to improve their competitiveness in this age of computer and IT. All the colleges have been networked through computer. This aims at providing the new techniques of education management to colleges. Besides, automation of college libraries is in progress.

Action is also being taken to provide new facilities to the 2 lakh 85 thousand odd college students in the state. The amount of scholarship provided to scheduled caste and scheduled tribe students for research work has been increased from Rs. five thousand to Rs. eight thousand. The books and stationery allowance for these students has also been increased.

A novel Gaon Ki Beti scheme has been implemented to provide higher education facility to meritorious girl students of rural areas. Under this, the girls of every village passing the XII examination in first division are given a scholarship of Rs. five hundred per month to pursue further studies. Sincere efforts have been made to link education to employment for which an action plan has been executed. Entrepreneurship development, computer education and environment education have been introduced in the foundation course of the first year of graduation for expansion of IT education and implementation of the Industrial Promotion Policy of the state government. An EDUSAT programme and Virtual Classrooms have also been started. The Higher Education Department has also launched a Swami Vivekanand Career Guidance Scheme to inform the students about career prospects. Career guidance cells and placement cells have been set up in all the colleges.

The state government has paid due attention to development of infrastructure in colleges over the last five years.

Special attention has been given to ensuring quality in establishment of new private colleges, for which new rules have been enforced from May 25, 2007.

It can, thus, be justifiably claimed that successfully facing the challenges Madhya Pradesh is fast moving towards becoming a higher education hub.

